

appeals to both casual drinkers and cocktail enthusiasts", adds Khanna. And that makes sense. The versatility of the liqueur definitely makes it multi-dimensional.

Price Delhi: ₹1,570; Haryana: ₹1,600; Uttarakhand: ₹1,840; Goa: ₹1,850

CELEBRATING THE EAST

While Indian producers are connecting the origins play of various influences of the country, Eekh's Nolen Gur Coffee Rum Liqueur accentuates it further. The liqueur is birthed from a collaboration between Goa's Eekh Rum, and Indore's Siolim Coffee Roasters, that's sweetened with Bengal's Nolen Gur. When was the last time you had Nolen Gur in your bottle of spirit? Chances are, never! Created from the sap of fresh date palm, Nolen Gur lends a distinct toasty, caramely, nutty profile to the mix, with a melt-in-your-mouth texture. The jaggery was awarded a GI Tag in 2022, recognising its uniqueness, and adding it to India's elaborate heritage that the world too now celebrates. "Enthusiasts enjoy discovering coffee in new formats, while experimental drinkers are drawn to the unique flavour profiles. Many also appreciate the slightly stimulating character and aromatic comfort that coffee-based spirits bring, especially in cocktails and dessert-style drinks", says Simian Singh, co-creator of the spirit.
Price Goa: ₹1, 610 (750ml); Available only in Goa

Of course, these aren't the only brews that have helped craft the new narrative around coffee-accented tipples. There's Segrado Aldeia's Cafe Rum, Greater Than's No Sleep Gin, Old Monk's XO Cafe, and Stranger & Sons' Filtr as examples of experiments with nearly every format of alcohol, not just spirits. Moonshine Meadery's Coffee Mead, BIRA91's Malabar Stout, and Paapi's Coffee Absinthe are only a few that have sung for the cause. While these developments are exciting, they come with a caveat: The risk of overcomplicating can deter the consumer from trying. Then, there's a chance that too many labels or simply trying to jump on the wave may leave the segment confused and crowded. While these can be concerns for the future, for the present moment, it's time to return to our tables, relish a sip, appreciate the good life, and the tipples that make it worthwhile.

WHERE BEANS MEET DREAMS

Segrado Aldeia's Cafe Rum
₹1,650

Greater Than's No Sleep Gin
Goa ₹1,000; Bengaluru ₹2,400; Maharashtra ₹1,850

Old Monk's XO Cafe
Goa ₹715

Stranger & Sons' Filtr
Maharashtra ₹2,999; Goa ₹2,120

Paapi's Coffee Absinthe
Goa ₹2,950; Maharashtra ₹3,450